

Foundations Overview

Your one-page map for Module 1 · Foundations of Family Wellness

The idea in one sentence

The 90 days before conception are a workshop, not a waiting room: sperm are rebuilt in about three months and an egg completes its final growth in a similar window (Heller & Clermont, *Science*; Gougeon, *Human Reproduction*), and epigenetic research shows that how you live in that window writes instructions that can reach the next generation (PNAS 2008; *European Journal of Human Genetics* 2006; *The Lancet* 2018 preconception series).

The five pillars

PILLAR	WHAT IT COVERS	WHERE THE COURSE GOES DEEPER
Nutrition	What you fuel with, and what you crave	Module 2
Movement	Circulation, mood, metabolic health, joyful activity	Module 3
Stress	How your nervous system talks to your hormones	Module 4
Toxins	Everyday exposures in food, home, water, air and personal care	Module 5
Connection	Partner, family and community support	Module 6

The pillars hold each other up. Weaken one and the others carry extra weight; strengthen one and every other pillar gets lighter.

Module 1 at a glance

TRAINING	RUNTIME	RESOURCE	ACTIONS (XP)	TOTAL
T1 · Introduction to Pre-Conception Health	10 min	Self-Assessment.pdf + Wellness Quiz	Quiz 50 · Journal baseline 30 · Forum 20	100
T2 · Understanding Cravings and Triggers	12 min	Triggers Worksheet.pdf	Identify 3 triggers 40 · Log 3 days 30 · Forum 20	90

TRAINING	RUNTIME	RESOURCE	ACTIONS (XP)	TOTAL
T3 · Building a Wellness Mindset	8 min	Affirmations Audio.mp3 + Cards & Vision Board Guide	Daily affirmation 30 · Vision board photo 40 · Share 20	90
T4 · Partner Involvement Basics	10 min	Partner Agreement.pdf	Review 40 · 15-min meeting 30 · Forum 20	90
T5 · Module Review & Reflection	7 min	Reflection Journal.pdf	3 takeaways 50 · 1-week intention 30	80
Module completion bonus				10

The key science you'll meet this module

- **Harvard Nurses' Health Study II** (Chavarro et al., *Obstetrics & Gynecology*, 2007): women following a whole-food, healthy-fat, plant-protein, active pattern had a 66% lower risk of ovulation-related infertility.
- **Cravings and the brain** (Volkow et al., *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*; Lennerz/Ludwig et al., *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*): high-glycemic foods create a blood-sugar rebound that activates the brain's craving centre hours later.
- **Sugar-sweetened drinks and conception** (Hatch et al., *Epidemiology*, 2018): one or more sugary drinks a day was associated with roughly 20% lower monthly fecundability in both partners.
- **Growth mindset** (Dweck; Blackwell et al., *Child Development*): believing your body can learn improves persistence.
- **Self-affirmation and stress** (Creswell et al., *Psychological Science*): reflecting on your values lowers the cortisol response to stress.
- **Couples change together** (Jackson, Steptoe & Wardle, *JAMA Internal Medicine*, 2015): when one partner adopts a healthier habit, the other is far more likely to follow.
- **Implementation intentions** (Gollwitzer & Sheeran, *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology*): "When X, I will Y" plans dramatically improve follow-through.

Your "why" for this module

Before you press play on Training 1, finish this sentence in your journal:

"I'm building these foundations because, for my future family, I want _____."

Ground rules

- Grace over guilt. A logged craving you still ate is a completed assignment.
- Baby steps. One change per training is enough.
- Be known. Post at least once in the forum this week.
- Medical first. Nothing here replaces your doctor.

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.